THE BURGESS PERSIAN LETTERS

Edited by BENJAMIN SCHWARTZ

PART VIII — *Conclusion*

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Gul Ahek near Tehran, June 29, 1849*

I enclose you a document to enable you to act for me with regard to the property left by my poor mother;[123] I doubt whether this will do but we can not get any regular powers of attorney in Persia and if such a thing is necessary you had better send me out one for me to sign here. Messrs Scott Bell Co of New Broad Street London, who know me as one of Cormick's executors and who have been in the habit of sending powers of attorney to Persia about Cormick's estate business, will tell you how this ought to be done. If my uncle pays you the money you can pay it into either Scott Bell C° or F. Ede and Sons so that I may draw against it if I want it.

I have come out of town for a day or two to this village which is situated towards the mountains and is the place of the British Mission and the other English pass the summer months [here] to avoid the great heats and bad climate of Tehran; I have not yet moved out of town because the King is still at his summer palace just outside the walls, and those in the service are obliged to be near, and it is uncertain whether he will go up towards the hills during the summer or not. I shall try to get leave during the Ramazan (the Mahomedan fast month) and come and live with my friend Abbott the consul; this month falls this year, from the 20*th* July to 19*th* Aug*t* and the King talks of going up to the hills during this month, if so I do not think I shall be obliged to go with him, as his will not be a standing camp. I hear there are some most beautiful places in the range of mountains to the north, with some fine trout streams and a very cool climate. I enjoy coming out here for a day or two very much and feel like a cockney come to Richmond for the Sunday.

The war in Khorassan still continues indeed I am sorry to say that our troops do not appear to be any nearer putting down this insurrection than six months ago, except that the rebel chief the Salar is pretty much confined to the capital of the province Meshed. Until this war is finished we shall not get on well, the governors of the other provinces will not send in their revenues regularly, nor will the people pay them, until we are fairly masters of Khorassan. This makes the government very hard up for money and consequently people are not regularly paid.

[123] A letter from Edward addressed to his uncle, George Ridsdale, and certified by Richard W. Stevens, British consul at Tabriz, authorizes George Burgess, Edward's brother, to act as his (E's) agent in the receipt of money or other property left by their mother, Frances Burgess.

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